Force Majeure

S&P −1.51% to 6,507 as Iraq halts oil exports. Brent tops $112. Russell enters correction. Fourth straight losing week. Gold posts worst week since 1983.

THE SESSION

Iraq declared force majeure on all foreign-operated oilfields Friday afternoon, and the session broke. The S&P 500 fell 1.51% to 6,507, its lowest close since early September and its fourth consecutive losing week. The Dow shed 444 points (−0.96%). The Nasdaq dropped 2.01%. The Russell 2000 declined 2.26% and officially entered correction territory—a 10% drawdown from its recent high—making it the first major index to cross that threshold. The VIX surged 11.3% to 26.78.

The catalyst was unmistakable. Iraq's oil ministry confirmed it could no longer ship crude through the Strait of Hormuz, with storage capacity at its limits. Brent closed at $112.19, up 3.3% on the day and nearly 9% on the week. WTI settled at $98.32. Drones struck two refineries in Kuwait overnight, adding to the supply picture. Saudi officials told the Wall Street Journal that crude could reach $180 if disruptions persist through late April. Citi raised its near-term Brent forecast to $120, with a $150 bull case.

The morning's brief flagged the deceleration in selling pace and the paper-versus-physical oil divergence. That thesis was upended by the Iraq force majeure—the de-leveraging the brief identified did not exhaust before the next supply shock arrived. CBS reported the Pentagon is preparing to deploy ground forces, and speculation grew around a plan to seize Kharg Island's oil export hub. Netanyahu said the war could end sooner than expected, but the market treated that as posture rather than substance.

Gold fell 2.0% to $4,513, posting its worst week since 1983 according to Bloomberg. The forced-liquidation pattern identified in Thursday's brief continued: gold selling into a war that should be gold-positive, driven by dollar strength and margin calls overwhelming fundamentals. Bitcoin held relatively flat at $69,838, down just 0.12%—a notable divergence from the broader risk-off tone.

Energy was the sole sector in the green, gaining 1.5%. Real estate (−2.0%), utilities (−1.7%), and technology (−1.4%) led the decline. Today's quadruple witching—the simultaneous expiration of trillions in derivatives—amplified intraday swings throughout the session.

IOWN Tactical: S&P at 6,507. The −20% trigger at ~5,600 remains 14% below current levels. The Russell has entered correction; the Dow and Nasdaq sit roughly 8% from their highs and are approaching that same threshold. Discipline over impulse—we do not act on sentiment, we act on structure.

IOWN HOLDINGS: NOTABLE MOVERS

WINNERS

SYF +1.04% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Consumer finance held firm as credit quality data remained stable. Synchrony gained ground while the broader market sold off, reflecting defensive demand for consumer-linked financials with strong earnings visibility.

OKE +0.93% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Midstream infrastructure continued to work as energy logistics repriced. ONEOK benefits directly from the structural shift in US energy flows as Gulf transit risk elevates domestic pipeline and processing demand.

DGX +0.57% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Defensive healthcare diagnostics drew buyers in a risk-off session. Quest's recurring revenue model and pricing power make it a natural destination when volatility rises.

CVX +0.14% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Chevron finished fractionally green as Brent crossed $112. With a breakeven well below $50 Brent, the refiner and upstream operator generates substantial free cash flow at these levels.

CHD +0.12% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Church & Dwight's consumer staples positioning provided a modest haven. The stock has held up well through the four-week drawdown, consistent with its low-beta profile.

DECLINERS

MARA –8.24% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Bitcoin miners bore the brunt of risk-off sentiment despite BTC itself holding near $70K. MARA's leveraged exposure to crypto and elevated energy costs created a double headwind as oil surged.

HUT –5.34% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Hut 8 followed MARA lower on the same crypto-mining dynamics. The stock has given back its post-GTC gains as the broader market de-risks.

HOOD –4.41% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Robinhood retreated sharply as retail trading sentiment soured. Coinbase launched stock perpetual futures contracts, introducing competitive pressure alongside the broader risk-off move.

KEYS –4.37% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Keysight gave back gains after a strong run following its earnings beat. The stock had surged 15%+ post-Q1 results and is now giving back some of that advance as the broad tech selloff accelerates.

BKH –4.34% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Black Hills was the weakest Dividend Strategy name as utilities sold off hard (−1.7% sector). Rate-sensitive names absorbed the repricing of higher-for-longer rate expectations following gold's collapse and oil's surge.

HOLDINGS NEWS

Coinbase (COIN, −2.67%) launched stock perpetual futures contracts, expanding its derivatives offering. Baird raised its price target to $215, citing crypto price appreciation. The stock still fell with the broader risk-off move, but the product expansion strengthens the platform's moat in institutional crypto infrastructure.

General Dynamics (GD, −1.10%) was selected by the US Navy to boost submarine production, reinforcing GD's position as a core defense contractor. With the Pentagon requesting $200B in additional war funding and sending Marines to the Middle East, the defense industrial base remains central to policy. GD's decline reflected the broad market's risk-off character rather than any fundamental deterioration.

Colgate-Palmolive (CL, −0.44%) was cited in a Dallas Fed analysis estimating that a sustained Hormuz shutdown could reduce global growth by 2.9% in Q2. CL's global supply chain has some exposure to rerouting costs, but its pricing power and essential-goods positioning should absorb the pressure.

PORTFOLIO PERFORMANCE

DIVIDEND STRATEGY ✓ BEAT BOTH

–1.34%

vs. DVY –1.60% | IWS –1.94%

GROWTH PORTFOLIO ✗ TRAIL

–2.26%

vs. IUSG –1.98%

YEAR-TO-DATE

Dividend +3.40% vs DVY +3.39% / IWS +3.09%
Growth –3.88% vs IUSG –7.62%